

from the age of six and he began composing in his teens.

In 1858, the Griegs received a visit from the violinist Ole Bull, one of Norway's most famous musicians. After hearing Edvard play, he advised the boy's parents to send him to the prestigious Leipzig Conservatory. Grieg claimed later that he hated the place, but he nevertheless derived some benefit from the teachings of the composer Ignaz Moscheles; he also developed a love for the music of Schumann, particularly after hearing it performed by his widow, Clara. At this time, Grieg's ambition was to establish himself as a concert pianist, but he felt dissatisfied with his musical training, so, in 1863, he moved to Copenhagen for further instruction. Here, he received advice from Niels Gade, leader of the Scandinavian Romantic school. Gade gave Grieg encouragement, but also chided him for the meager amount of his compositions.

On a more positive note, Grieg met and became engaged to his cousin, the singer Nina Hagerup. The couple married in 1867.

